



The inauguration hall on Day 1, prior to the arrival of the crowds



Ramesh Chopra, founder and editor, Electronics For You, welcoming the guests and attendees



Regunath Balasubramanian, principal architect of the UIDAI project with EFY editor Ramesh Chopra, lighting the lamp to inaugurate OSI 2011



Gianugo Rabellino, senior director for Open Source Communities, Microsoft Corporation, USA, delivering the keynote: "Microsoft, Open Source, And Interoperability—What's Ahead?"

by Gianugo Rabellino, senior director, Microsoft Corporation, USA. "Microsoft is more open than you may think, and we want to show the interoperability and openness between Microsoft and non-Microsoft platforms," he explained. He spoke about how the software giant has decided to be more open in the mobile, server, cloud and client space. According to Rabellino, Microsoft employees are active in the community and contribute to projects like Samba. He stated, "I truly believe that Microsoft has become open. It would be stupid if we said Microsoft Hyper-V Server will handle only Windows. It will work on Linux too." Even Microsoft sees strong business opportunities in FOSS. Rabellino said, "We're not going open because it is cool, but because it makes solid business sense." Meanwhile, Oracle also wanted to let the community know that they do not consider MySQL secondary, but view it as one of its important products.

The commercial viability of FOSS

In keeping with its agenda, OSI Days included sessions on the commercial aspects of open source. For all those who believe that free and open source software cannot make money, OSI Days had a different story to tell. Speakers like Gil Yehuda (Yahoo! Inc), Rohit Kumar Rai (EnterpriseDB) and Ryusuke Kajiyama (Oracle) cited examples on how an organisation can create revenue models by using, developing or supporting open source.

Issues in the FOSS industry came to the fore

One of the problems discussed at the conference was the need to commercialise FOSS. Many strongly believed that technology companies in the FOSS business need to market themselves well to become commercially viable. Kapil Gupta, founder and CEO of OMLogic Consulting, talked about the best practices and the dos and don'ts from a marketing standpoint. His talk on 'Boost Your Business with Web 2.0' delved into viral marketing and its impact for open source businesses. "Technology companies, especially open source companies, don't market themselves well. They should differentiate themselves. An easy way to do this is by leveraging the social media to build the brand of the company," said Gupta.

The legal issues involved in using and distributing software that contains open source were also discussed at length. Mishi Choudhary, director, International Practice, the Software Freedom Law Center (SFLC) in New York and executive director of New Delhi-based sflc.in, shared her views on the importance of simplicity and FOSS compliance. Choudhary shared, "FOSS compliance is simple and important, and is available in India. The model has moved to multi-source development, and so, it is important to understand obligations to avoid legal costs, reputation and business costs." Her talk on 'Free and Open Source Compliance and Industry Best Practices: What You Must Know!' covered the compliance issues and their effect on proprietary code, exposure to intellectual property infringement law suits, the compliant usage of FOSS, an organisation's relationship with the FOSS community, and industry best practices.

FOSS is for everyone

There were sessions at OSI aimed at promoting awareness about and